



Assigning user names



Turning on Automatic Updates

Next, you are given the option of either registering your copy of Windows with Microsoft right then or at a later date. Registration is optional. If you're registered, you'll be notified about new products, updates, events, promotions and special offers from Microsoft. If you do not have an Internet connection, select 'No' and click 'Next'.

In the screen that follows, you will be asked to enter the names of the users who will use the computer. Separate user accounts with these names are created—these can be later personalised. You need to enter your name in order to proceed to the next screen and complete the XP setup.

3.2 Installing Device Drivers

After you are done installing Windows XP, there remain some things that need to be done before you can start using it. The first step is installing the latest service pack (Service Pack 2, or SP2). SP2 addresses many issues—it fixes security loopholes, known bugs, and so on. It also includes several enhancements and features such as the Security Center, which monitors the status of your anti-virus program and your firewall, and manages automatic updates—besides checking if your virus definitions are updated. Then there is Windows Media Player 9 and DirectX 9.0c as also an updated version of Internet Explorer 6. Another important feature of SP2 is the inclusion of a better and more robust Windows Firewall, and Data Execution Prevention (DEP) which helps protect against viruses and other security threats.